CYBERWARFARE

Cyberwarfare takes place when computer technicians or automated computer software programs break into an enemy's computers, an activity known as hacking, to learn strategic information or conduct sabotage. For example, a technician working for the US military might hack into an enemy country's defense systems to learn where their troops are moving and what kinds of weapons they are using. A technician might then sabotage the enemy's missile launch codes so the weapons do not operate correctly. Other examples of cyberwarfare might include shutting down websites or social media sites or disrupting a country's power systems.

MDR. Most communications flow through without stopping, whereas others are kept temporarily or indefinitely.

Snowden thought the massive capture of information was disturbing enough. Then he discovered an NSA cyberwarfare program he considered even worse. Called MonsterMind, the program in development at the NSA would look for suspected cyberattacks, block them from entering the country, then automatically send a cyberattack back to the country of origin. Because foreign cyberattacks are often routed through innocent third countries, that meant an innocent country might be the recipient of a US cyberattack. Plus, for the program to work effectively, virtually every private communication coming from overseas would have to be captured.

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